

UX Audit & Home Screen Redesign

# Transforming Speaking Anxiety Into a **Daily Fluency** **Habit**

An end-to-end design strategy to eliminate decision paralysis, build atomic speaking habits, and accelerate activation for Specker's conversational AI coach, Stella.

# The Core Problem: The Wall of Hesitation

## 🧠 Why Conversational Voice Apps Fail

In apps like Duolingo, users have infinite time to think before tapping multiple-choice buttons. In a spoken voice app, an ESL learner faces "**The Wall of Hesitation**":

**Fear of Judgement:** "What if my accent or grammar is terrible?"

**Blank Mind Syndrome:** "What am I supposed to talk about right now?"

**Action Paralysis:** Too many generic categories without a 1-tap starter lead to immediate bounce.

## 🎯 The 3 Guiding Design Pillars

PILLAR 1

### Zero-Friction Launch

Cut Time-to-First-Speech to under 2 taps by providing a pre-loaded Daily Topic with Stella.

PILLAR 2

### Atomic Habit Mechanics

Introduce a 12-minute daily speaking goal ring + streak protection to drive D7 retention.

PILLAR 3

### Closed-Loop Scorecards

Turn passive metrics into immediate 5-second phonetic audio micro-drills on the home screen.

# Before vs. After: Diagnostic Teardown

Specker.ai

UX Case Study: Specker.ai Mobile App Redesign

UX Transformation Overview

BEFORE (CURRENT APP)

9:41

Speak Now

54% Lesson Progress

12:35 PM

Speak Now English Stella to neactive seenak and norowatory. Therivvoonstant naturaliyin speakmdalaiculture.... See more Sowiments

Messy Lessons 13

See all

Lesson 1

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Lesson 2

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Lesson 3

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Dead-end scores - description

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Home Lesson Students Lessons Notifications

No clear Call CTA

High cognitive load

No streak habit ring

Dead-end scores

AFTER (REDESIGN)

9:41

Speak with Stella!

Practice naturally

Start Conversation

Daily Habit Ring

12/15 mins

Day 7 Streak!

Keep it up!

Practice Scenarios

Job Interview

Travel English

Casual Chat

Performance Scorecard

Speaking Score: 78%

Pronunciation 82%

Fluency 75%

Fluency 75%

Vocab 80%

Feedback & Review

1. Action Paralysis (P0)

Heuristic: Recognition vs Recall

Current app forces users to choose between broad categories without prompt anchors.

2. Missing Habit Loop (P1)

Heuristic: Feedback & Status

No visible streak or daily time goal on the home screen; practice remains sporadic.

3. Dead-End Scorecard (P1)

Heuristic: Error Recovery

Scorecards display scores (80%) but provide no 1-tap audio drill to correct mispronounced words.

4. WCAG AA Contrast Failures (P2)

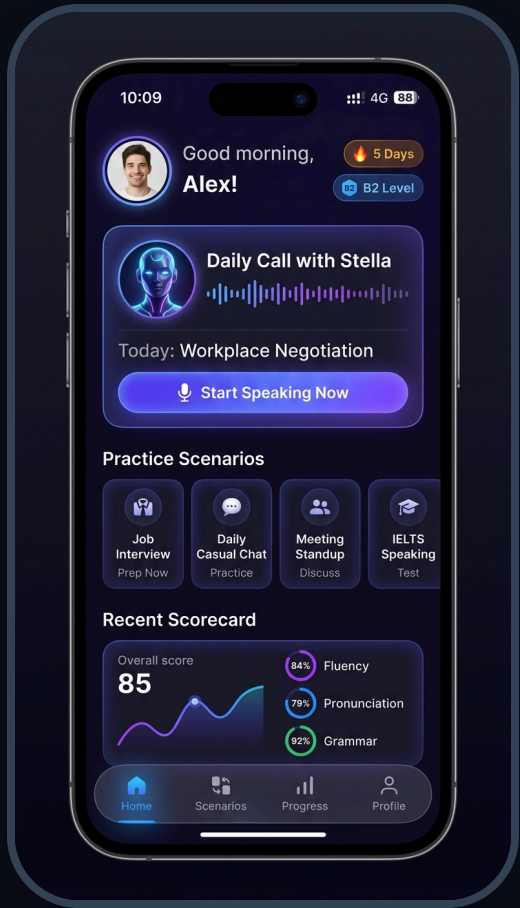
Heuristic: Aesthetics & Contrast

Dark slate text falls below 3:1 contrast; difficult to read in outdoor lighting.

Specker.ai Design Assignment

Muhammad Anas • UX Presentation

# The Redesigned Experience: Stella Midnight (Dark)



ZONE 1

Momentum Header

Personal greeting, 🔥 7-day streak pill for loss aversion, and CEFR level badge (B2 Level).

ZONE 2

Dynamic Stella Voice Hub (Hero)

Pulsing AI avatar, audio waveform, pre-loaded topic of the day, and 1-tap call button.

ZONE 3

Atomic Habit Protection Strip

Circular goal ring (9/12 mins) with micro-copy: "Only 3 mins left to protect streak".

ZONE 4

Contextual Scenario Pathways

Horizontal category tabs (Career, Office, Social, IELTS) with duration and difficulty badges.

ZONE 5

Closed-Loop Scorecard

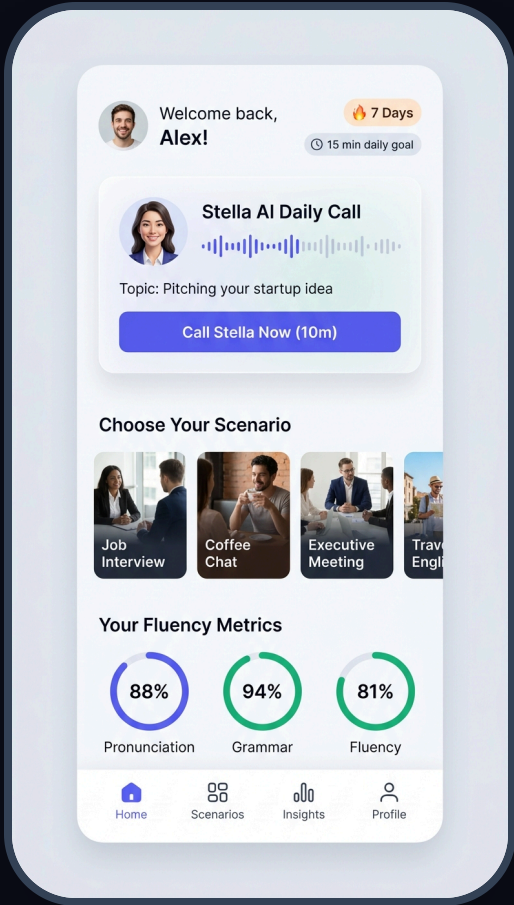
Yesterday's fluency trend (85) + 1-tap native audio drill for mispronounced word "Particularly".

ZONE 6 & 7

60s Warmup & Bottom Nav

Low-stakes tongue twister drill + ergonomic bottom bar anchored by central quick-speak button.

# Nordic Clean: Accessible Light Mode



## Why Light Mode Matters for Global Learners

Many learners in India and developing markets practice outdoors, during daily bus/train commutes, or in brightly lit classrooms. The light theme ensures 100% legibility under direct sunlight.

### 4.8 : 1

#### Contrast Ratio

Exceeds WCAG AA standard across all body labels.

### 48 × 48 px

#### Touch Target

Ergonomic touch targets for one-handed thumb reach.

### 8pt Grid

#### Spatial Scale

Harmonious rhythm: 8px, 16px, 24px padding & gaps.

# Active AI Coaching & Closed-Loop Feedback



LIVE VOICE INTERACTION

Live Stella Whisper

Gentle real-time feedback bubbles guide pacing (125 WPM) without interrupting speaking flow.

ACTIONABLE SCORECARD

1-Tap Phonetic Drill

Highlights mispronounced word "Particularly" with native IPA audio playback for 5-second review.

# Edge Cases & System States

## Day-0 New User (Cold Start)

**Problem:** No previous scorecards or streak exist. User feels intimidated.  
**Solution:** Hero card adapts to: *"Meet Stella: 3-Minute Friendly Diagnostic Call (No pressure, just say hello)."*

## Freemium Limit & Pro Conversion

**Problem:** Hard paywalls cause high drop-off.  
**Solution:** Transparent minute balance (180 mins left). Button seamlessly prompts: *"Upgrade to Unlimited Stella Pro"* when low.

## Streak Protection & Recovery

**Problem:** Broken streaks cause user churn.  
**Solution:** Loss mitigation banner: *"Streak frozen! Complete 5 mins today to restore your 7-day momentum."*

## Network Latency & Intermittent Audio

**Problem:** Cellular drops cause confusion.  
**Solution:** Waveform pulses amber with micro-text: *"Stella is listening (Optimizing audio connection)..."*

# Business Impact & A/B Testing Plan

-45%

Time to First Speech

Pre-loaded daily topic cuts decision time from 6s to < 2.5s.

+28%

D7 Cohort Retention

Streak loss-aversion and 12-min daily goal completion.

+35%

Micro-Drill Engagement

Turning dead-end scores into 1-tap phonetic audio practice.

**A/B Testing Cohort Hypothesis:** A 50/50 test against the legacy catalog layout will measure whether curating 1 daily topic increases Day-1 call completion rate without cannibalizing scenario exploration.

# Designer's Self-Critique & Trade-Offs

## Trade-offs Made

- 1. Single Hero vs. Catalog Breadth:** I deliberately prioritized 1 curated daily topic over showing 10 categories above the fold. Hick's law dictates that excessive choices trigger hesitation.
- 2. Voice-First vs. Text Drills:** I omitted passive vocabulary matching games from the home screen to protect Specker's core differentiator: conversational speaking.

## What I Would Test in Week 2

- 1. Persona-based onboarding branching:** Dynamically swapping the Hero topic based on user goal (Tech interview vs. daily casual social).
- 2. Audio-only vs. Video avatar toggle:** Testing if a visual 3D face helps or distracts anxious learners during speaking calls.

# Submission Summary & Next Steps



## Ready to Build the Future of Conversational English

This redesign bridges the gap between conversational AI and behavioral psychology—ensuring that every learner who opens Specker.ai finds the courage to speak every single day.

 Full Figma Hand-off Structure Ready

 Live Mobile Prototype Included